

conjunction

A word or phrase used to connect words, phrases, and clauses.

consonant

A letter of the alphabet that is not a vowel.

contraction

A shortened form of a word or words, in which letters are omitted from the middle and replaced with an apostrophe.

coordinating conjunction

A word that connects words, phrases, and clauses of equal importance.

dangling participle

When a modifying phrase or clause that starts with a participle is put in the wrong place in a sentence, and has no subject to hold on to.

dialect

The informal vocabulary and grammar used by a particular social or geographic group.

direct object

The person or thing directly affected by the action of the verb.

direct speech

Text that represents spoken words and is written in quotation marks.

exaggeration

When something is represented as larger or better than it actually is.

exclamation

A sentence that expresses a strong emotion, such as surprise, or a raised voice, and ends in an exclamation point.

fact

A statement that can be proved.

first person narrative

When an author writes a piece from his or her point of view, using *I* and *my*.

gerund

The name given to the present participle when it is used as a noun.

headline

The statement at the top of an article that tells the reader what the article is about.

hyperbole

An extreme form of exaggeration that may not be taken seriously, but grabs the reader's attention.

hyperlink

A word, phrase, or icon on the World Wide Web, which, if clicked, takes the user to a new document or website.

indefinite pronoun

A pronoun such as *everyone* that refers to nobody or nothing specific.

indirect object

The person or thing indirectly affected by the action of the verb.

indirect question

A sentence that reports a question that has been asked, without expecting an answer, and ends in a period.

infinitive

The simplest form of a verb: the form that is used in dictionaries.

interjection

A word or phrase that occurs alone and expresses emotion.

intonation

The variation of pitch and loudness in a person's voice.

intransitive verb

A verb that does not require an object.

italics

A style of type in which the letters are printed at an angle to resemble handwriting.

jargon

A type of slang that includes specialized terms that are used and understood by a select, often professional, group of people.

linking verb

A verb, such as *be*, that joins the subject of a sentence to a word or phrase—often an adjective—that describes the subject.

main clause

A group of words that contains a subject and a verb and makes complete sense on its own.